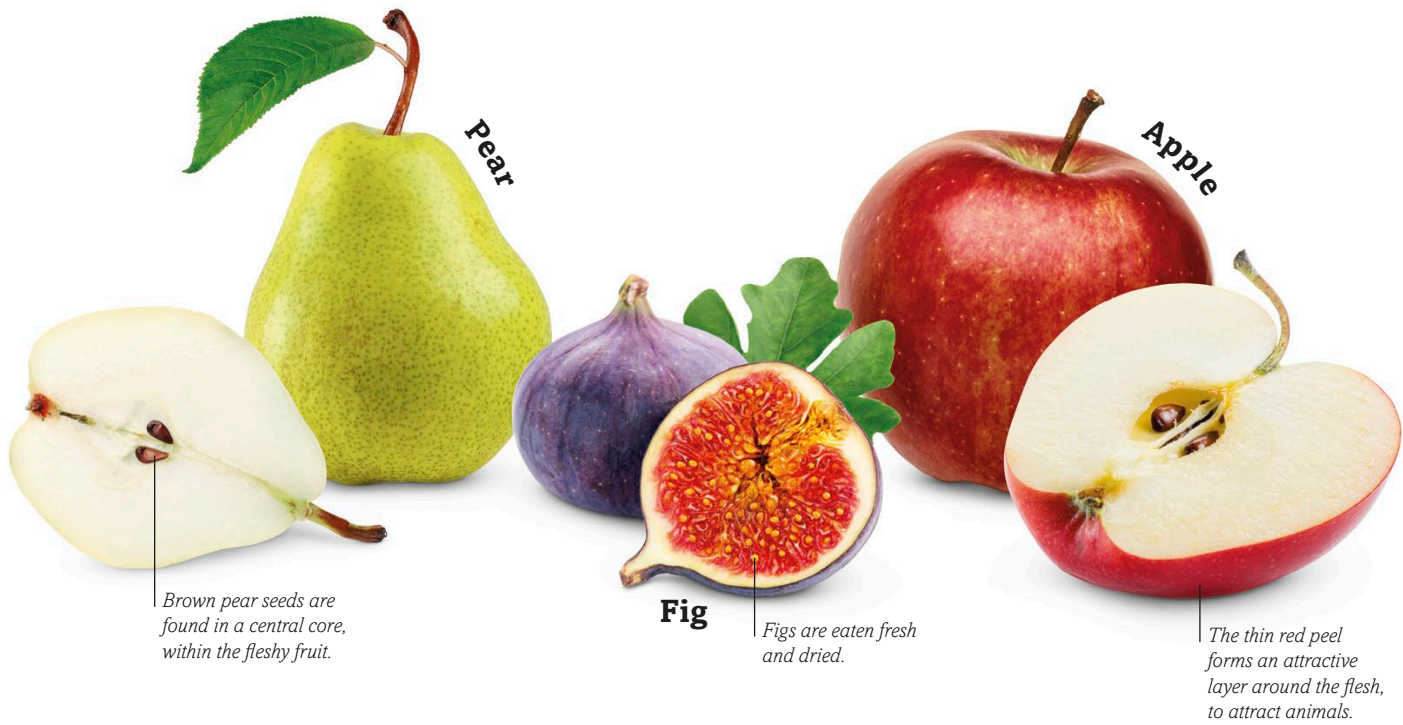




Brown pear seeds are found in a central core, within the fleshy fruit.

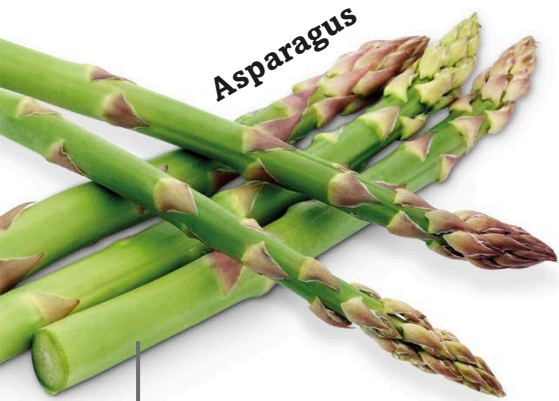
Fig

Figs are eaten fresh and dried.

The thin red peel forms an attractive layer around the flesh, to attract animals.

Fruit or vegetable?

Any part of a plant we eat is either a fruit or a vegetable. Fruits develop from fertilized flowers, and contain seeds that are spread when they are eaten. Any edible part of the plant that is not a fruit is a vegetable. This can be a root, a stem, a leaf, or even the buds of developing flowers.



Asparagus

Stem ➤ A stem transports food to and from the roots of a plant and is full of minerals. When stems are soft enough, they can be eaten as vegetables, raw or cooked.

False fruits and vegetables

We often use the terms “fruit” and “vegetable,” based on how we eat plants—in sweet or savory dishes—rather than how they grow. So, a sweet-tasting vegetable is sometimes called a fruit, while a savory salad fruit may be called a vegetable!



Rhubarb is an example of a false fruit. It is actually a stem vegetable.



A tomato is an example of a false vegetable. It is actually a fruit.